ENGLISH
BALBHARATI
GRADE ONE

FOR FREE DISTRIBUTION

- **Tele-MANAS Program**

Tele-MANAS (Tele Mental Health Assistance and Networking Across States) (14416/ 1800-89-14416)

Under the National Mental Health Program, the centrally sponsored scheme 'Tele-MANAS' is being implemented in the state of Maharashtra from October 2022. Under the Tele-MANAS Program, free 24 × 7 integrated and comprehensive mental health services are provided through the helpline number 14416. This includes treatment and counselling by experts for various mental problems. The information provided by you after calling the Tele-MANAS helpline remains completely confidential, so students, parents and teachers should feel free to call the helpline number and tell them about their problems and doubts and get guidance on it. Tell others to take help from this facility as well.

Tele-MANAS app has been launched by the Central Government and is also available in Marathi language. This app provides complete information about mental health. Tele-MANAS app is available free of cost.

This textbook aligns with the curriculum and syllabus developed by the State Council of Educational Research and Training (SCERT), Maharashtra, Pune-30 and has been verified by them. The Coordination Committee, established under Government Resolution by GR No. Abhyas - 2116/(Pra.Kra.43/16) SD - 4 dated April 25, 2016, approved this textbook in its meeting held on April 16, 2025 for use from academic year 2025-26 onwards.

ENGLISH BALBHARATI

Grade One

Maharashtra State Bureau of Textbook Production and Curriculum Research, Pune.

समग्र शिक्षा

Scan the adjacent QR code with your smartphone to access digital resources, including audio, visual and audio-visual materials, that complement this textbook.

First Edition : 2025
Reprint : 2026

© Maharashtra State Bureau of Textbook Production and Curriculum Research, Pune - 411 004.

The Maharashtra State Bureau of Textbook Production and Curriculum Research reserves all rights relating to the book. No part of this book should be reproduced without the written permission of the Director, Maharashtra State Bureau of Textbook Production and Curriculum Research, 'Balbharati', Senapati Bapat Marg, Pune 411004.

English Language Committee :

Dr. Prashant Ramesh Dhande (Chairman)
Smt. Rupali Kiranrao Zanzad (Member)
Smt. Sangita Sanjay Raut (Member)
Shri. Sanjay Tukaram Pawar (Member)
Smt. Anuradha Ashok Kamat (Member)
Smt. Yogita Vasant Gaikwad (Member)
Smt. Jaya Kisan Eage (Member)
Shri. Mahesh Ladu Sawant (Member)
Smt.Vinita Jitendra Narang (Member)
Shri. Vaibhav Tukaram Mhaske (Member)
Shri. Nilesh Rameshrao Misal (Member)
Smt. Resmi Umesh Unnikrishnan (Member)
Shri. Prakash Pradip Harchekar (Member)
Shri. Radheshyam Gopal Patil (Member)

Cover : Shri. Bhatu Ramdas Bagale
Illustrations : Reshma Barve

Co-ordination :
Smt. Ketaki Jani
I/C Special Officer for English

Typesetting :
DTP Section (Languages)
Textbook Bureau, Pune.

Paper :
70 GSM Creamwove

Print Order No. :
N/PB/2026-27/(30,000)

Printer :
United Multicolour Printers
Pvt. Ltd, Pune

Publisher :
Shri. Sachin Mehta
I/c Controller
Maharashtra State
Textbook Bureau,
Prabhadevi,
Mumbai- 400 025.

Production :
Smt. Mitali Shitap
I/c Chief Production Officer

Shri. Rajendra Pandloskar
Production Officer

The Constitution of India

Preamble

WE, THE PEOPLE OF INDIA, having solemnly resolved to constitute India into a SOVEREIGN SOCIALIST SECULAR DEMOCRATIC REPUBLIC and to secure to all its citizens:

JUSTICE, social, economic and political;

LIBERTY of thought, expression, belief, faith and worship;

EQUALITY of status and of opportunity; and to promote among them all

FRATERNITY assuring the dignity of the individual and the unity and integrity of the Nation;

IN OUR CONSTITUENT ASSEMBLY this twenty-sixth day of November, 1949, do HEREBY ADOPT, ENACT AND GIVE TO OURSELVES THIS CONSTITUTION.

The Constitution of India

Chapter IV A

Fundamental Duties

ARTICLE 51A

Fundamental Duties - It shall be the duty of every citizen of India -

(a) to abide by the Constitution and respect its ideals and institutions, the National Flag and the National Anthem;

(b) to cherish and follow the noble ideals which inspired our national struggle for freedom;

(c) to uphold and protect the sovereignty, unity and integrity of India;

(d) to defend the country and render national service when called upon to do;

(e) to promote harmony and the spirit of common brotherhood amongst all the people of India transcending religious, linguistic and regional or sectional diversities, to renounce practices derogatory to the dignity of women;

(f) to value and preserve the rich heritage of our composite culture;

(g) to protect and improve the natural environment including forests, lakes, rivers and wild life and to have compassion for living creatures;

(h) to develop the scientific temper, humanism and the spirit of inquiry and reform;

(i) to safeguard public property and to abjure violence;

(j) to strive towards excellence in all spheres of individual and collective activity so that the nation constantly rises to higher levels of endeavour and achievement;

(k) who is a parent or guardian to provide opportunities for education to his child or, as the case may be, ward between the age of six and fourteen years.

NATIONAL ANTHEM

Jana-gana-mana-adhināyaka jaya hē
Bhārata-bhāgya-vidhātā,

Panjāba-Sindhu-Gujarāta-Marāthā
Drāvida-Utkala-Banga

Vindhya-Himāchala-Yamunā-Gangā
uchchala-jaladhi-taranga

Tava subha nāmē jāgē, tava subha āsisa māgē,
gāhē tava jaya-gāthā,

Jana-gana-mangala-dāyaka jaya hē
Bhārata-bhāgya-vidhātā,

Jaya hē, Jaya hē, Jaya hē,
Jaya jaya jaya, jaya hē.

PLEDGE

India is my country. All Indians are my brothers and sisters.

I love my country, and I am proud of its rich and varied heritage. I shall always strive to be worthy of it.

I shall give my parents, teachers and all elders respect, and treat everyone with courtesy.

To my country and my people, I pledge my devotion. In their well-being and prosperity alone lies my happiness.

Preface

Dear Children,

Now you are in Grade One. A most hearty welcome! We are happy to place this textbook **English Balbharati** for Grade One in your hands.

This textbook is prepared keeping in mind the Foundational Stage Curriculum 2024 which is based on the National Education Policy 2020. You will definitely like this textbook. Before entering into Grade One, in the pre-school (Balvatika) stages you are already familiar with some English letters as a part of / allied with language learning. You are already familiar with some songs, stories and various activities in English Language. In this year too, you will newly learn through this textbook activities like picture-description, songs and rhymes, stories, picture-stories, letters, vowels, language puzzles and language games. This textbook will definitely help you in laying the foundation of your language education and strengthening your ability to speak, read and write English language. The textbook includes content-related attractive and interactive pictures to make your learning more enjoyable and interesting.

There are many songs, poems and rhymes in this textbook. You will sing all those songs and poems with actions and in rhythmic way. You will be very happy to sing these songs. You will also enjoy various stories and picture-stories. You will surely rejoice in listening and telling these stories. You will chat and discuss the picture descriptions and immerse yourselves with the situation in them.

You have already learnt the English letters and their sounds. In this textbook, you will get more practice through Sound games and Word building activities. Further, you will enjoy building forming words, your own sentences and write a short paragraph. Many lessons are designed to give you insight into functional grammar. This will surely help you to learn English language in a playful manner and through practice. You will surely like the picturesque constructions and design of the book. You have to learn every letter and vowels through the practice. Once, you have identified letters and vowels, then you may write small words and small sentences gradually. Some language games are also given in the textbook. You have to learn English language in playful manner and through practice.

Your introduction to language will become more and more concrete through all of these things given in the textbook. At the end of Grade One, you will be able to speak, read and write English nicely. Friends, grow up while studying English with joy. Wish you all the best for your studies!

Pune

Date : 30 April 2025

Indian Solar Year : 10, Vaishakh, 1947
Akshayya Tritiya

(Krishnakumar Bhaskarrao Patil)

Director

Maharashtra State Bureau of Textbook
Production and Curriculum Research, Pune.

English Balbharati : Grade One
Mapping and Scope of Learning Outcomes

C.G.	Comp.	L. O. No.	Statement	Scope
9	9.1	9.1.1.1	Listens to longer (4-8 sentences) songs/poems (unfamiliar) with attention and have conversations about them and asks questions.	1.6, 2.5, 2.11, 3.11, 4.10
		9.1.2.1	Sings/recites longer (10 sentences) songs/ poems.	1.1, 2.1, 2.7, 3.5, 3.7, 4.1, 4.3
	9.2	9.2.1.1	Extends/Creates short poems/ rhymes with the help of the teacher.	1.2, 3.1
	9.3	9.3.1.1	Engages in conversations, wait for his/her turn to speak and allow other to speak.	1.7, 1.8, 2.2, 2.3, 3.8
		9.3.2.1	Engages with non-fictional content read aloud or discussed in class, links knowledge from his/her own experiences, and talks about it.	2.2, 2.7, 2.11, 2.12, 3.4, 3.6
	9.4	9.4.1.1	Follows instructions comprising of several steps. (8 to 9 instructions at a time)	1.3, 1.9, 2.7, 2.8, 3.6
		9.4.2.1	Gives clear instructions comprising of several steps. (8 to 9 instructions at a time)	1.9, 3.8
	9.5	9.5.1.1	Interprets the intent of the plot and emotions of the characters in a story and tells the story with dialogue.	2.10, 3.2, 3.9, 3.10, 4.7
	9.6	9.6.1.1	Narrates his/her own short stories with simple plots and characters.	2.10, 4.10,
	9.7	9.7.1.1	Predicts meaning of unknown words in texts using pictures and context clues.	1.10, 2.4
10	10.1	10.1.2.1	Separates sounds of syllables from the words.	1.4
		10.1.3.1	Breaks down sounds of vowels and consonants from the syllabic sounds.	1.4
	10.2	10.2.2.1	Recognises simple punctuation marks (full stop, question mark)	2.8
	10.3	10.3.1.1	Reads all aksharas (including samyuktaksharas) and connects to corresponding sounds.	1.5
		10.3.1.2	Recognises known double consonant words.	4.2,
		10.3.2.1	Reads multi-syllable frequently used words. (including consonant clusters)	2.3, 2.9, 4.2, 4.3
		10.3.3.1	Writes own words with the help of all aksharas and tells the sentences by using those words.	1.4, 2.4, 2.7
		10.3.4.1	Writes own sentences with the help of learnt letters.	3.11
	10.4	10.4.1.1	Reads short passages accurately with appropriate intonation, pauses.	2.6, 2.12, 3.6, 4.2, 4.9, 4.11
	10.5	10.5.1.1	Begins "Independent Reading" of books of equal textual and visual content.	3.4, 3.5, 4.5, 4.9
		10.5.2.1	Begins to read unfamiliar story books and comprehends with guidance from the teacher.	4.5, 4.6
		10.5.2.2	Identifies plots and characters.	4.5
10	10.6	10.6.1.1	Reads short poems and narrates the literal meaning of the poem.	1.6, 1.9, 4.10
	10.7	10.7.1.1	Reads simple instructions to play a game and plays it with a group.	3.8
	10.8	10.8.1.1	Forms sequence of pictures and writes short sentences in conventional script. (with the help of letters)	3.3, 2.7, 2.11
		10.8.1.2	Writes and describes picture scripts with the help of words and short sentences.	4.4
		10.8.2.1	Writes about 3-4 syllable words on dictation.	This L.O. is applicable for all the lessons.
		10.8.2.2	Writes 2-3 own sentences with the help of letters using alphabets (e.g. about his/her own experiences, describe picture or things)	3.11, 4.8
	10.9	10.9.1.1	Explains preferences in book choices and reads short books on a regular frequency.	2.8, 3.4, 3.5

First-grade children are expected to attain the outlined learning outcomes by year-end. Relevant content on various pages, not just those specified, can contribute to achieving these outcomes.

Instructions for Teachers and Parents

The curriculum for the Foundational Stage has been designed as per the SCF 2024 prepared by SCERT Maharashtra, Pune. The content in this textbook is derived from the sources that relate and reflect the children's experiences. Along with play-based activities and enquiry-based learning, it includes a focus on developing social skills.

This book attains optimal outcomes in the domains like physical and motor development, cognitive development, socio-emotional development, ethical development, cultural / aesthetic development, the development of communication and early language literacy. It is assumed that children learn best through play, interaction and hands-on activities. Here are some effective strategies to help them develop language, creativity and social skills through different language components.

Here's how teachers and parents can make learning an enjoyable experience by exploring these topics by fun and engaging methods. It is expected that the teachers / parents will follow the instructions given in the textbook to ensure the best learning experiences.

Phonological awareness

- Introduce sound/s of each letter.
- Help them to build words instead of rote learning.
- Show them how to break words into syllables and vice versa.

Poems

- Sing the poems / songs with rhythm and action.
- Ask children to replace some words to extend or create a new poem.

Stories

- Use props while enacting the story.
- Encourage children to use their imagination.
- Provide access to the children to read books of their choice.

Conversation / Picture talk

- Provide real-life situations to develop speaking skills.
- Give ample practice of conversation.
- Provide word bank for the picture talk and encourage conversation.

Games / puzzles / riddles

- Reinforce vocabulary through games, puzzles and riddles.
- Design more games to give ample practice.

Recipes / Art / Craft activites

- Give hands-on experience while teaching recipe, art and craft activities.
- Inculcate good healthy eating habits through talks and discussion.
- Ask children to work in a group to develop social skills.

Teaching book handling and inculcating reading habits

- Introduce different types of books available in the library.
- Show them how to turn pages gently.

Reading

- Develop reading habit.
- Help to improve reading by mastering phonetic awareness and proper intonation.

Writing

- Make sure that development of listening and speaking is acquired before developing writing skills.
- Ensure that child listens properly before taking dictation.
- Words given below the lessons must be used for the dictation.
- Develop a proper pattern of writing (e.g. spacing between words and use of punctuation marks.)

✦✦✦

Logos used in the Textbook

Listen | Speak/ Discuss | Sing a song | Listen and act | Read | See and do | Do

Enact | Colour the picture | Draw picture | Write | Activity | For the Teacher

CONTENTS

UNIT ONE		Page
1.1	**My First Day**	1
1.2	**Clap your hands.**	2
1.3	I know my alphabet.	3
1.4	Let us read.	5
1.5	Fun with Special Letters	7
1.6	**The Rainbow**	8
1.7	Meet my family.	10
1.8	Let us know each other.	11
1.9	**Everybody has a name.**	14
1.10	My Daily Routine	16

UNIT TWO		Page
2.1	**It's Time to Play**	18
2.2	Avni's Visit to a Park	19
2.3	In the Classroom	21
2.4	My House	23
2.5	**Weather**	26
2.6	Magic Words	27
2.7	**Things I Do**	28
2.8	Classroom Library	31
2.9	Our Vehicles	33
2.10	Himani and the Ladybug	35
2.11	**My Flower**	37
2.12	Festivals	38

UNIT THREE		Page
3.1	**Opposites**	41
3.2	Suyog makes friends.	42
3.3	The Fox and the Crow	44
3.4	Books are my best friends.	45
3.5	**Open a book.**	46
3.6	Raghu goes to the market.	48
3.7	**The Squirrel**	51
3.8	Alia falls sick.	52
3.9	The Ant and the Grasshopper	55
3.10	Minku, the Monkey	57
3.11	**My Kitty Cat**	59

UNIT FOUR		Page
4.1	**A boy went walking**	61
4.2	Harry, the Hippo	63
4.3	**Singing is Fun!**	65
4.4	A Walk in Nature	66
4.5	The Elephant and the Ants	67
4.6	Off to Mars!	69
4.7	Honest Abhi	71
4.8	A Joyful Day	73
4.9	A Gift for Mother	75
4.10	**Cookout**	77
4.11	Summer Holidays	78

Maharashtra State Bureau of Textbook Production and Curriculum Research, Pune acknowledges the kindness of the copyright holders for granting the permission to reproduce the copyright material. Some permission are awaited. Acknowledgement to them will be made in subsequent reprint.

(1) My First Day : A to Z Teacher's Stuff. (2) It's Time to Play : Devon Thagard/ Troy Mcdonald

(3) Everybody has a name : Jean Warren. (4) My Flower : Margaret Schrodr.

(5) My Kitty Cat : Ryan Gibbs (6) Cookout : Lauren Shirk